

That's Meshed Up Top

Reminiscent of the string vests my Granny made back in the 80s, here is my take on a classic mesh top. It is made to measure, top down, with raglan sleeves.

It can be long or short sleeved, and can be made to be fitted or oversized. This pattern is quick and fun to make and is suitable for beginners.



Designed by Vikki Bruff. Instagram: @vee_bee_x

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Skill Level

Beginner

Yarn Used

Paintbox Cotton DK

4 balls in black to make the long-sleeved top (UK 12/14)

Hooks used

4.5 mm

Other Supplies

4 stitch markers, darning needle

Allow extra balls of yarn for larger sizes —
approx. 50g per size



Tension

Any, as it is made to measure, adjusted to fit.

Sizing

Made to measure.

Hints and tips

Pattern is written in UK terms.

Keep measuring and trying on to ensure a perfect fit.

This pattern is worked in the round, do not turn your work at the end of the round

Abbreviations

beg	beginning
ch	chain
ch-sp	chain space
ch-	refers to ch made previously e.g. ch-3
dc	double crochet
dtr	double treble crochet
sm	Stitch marker

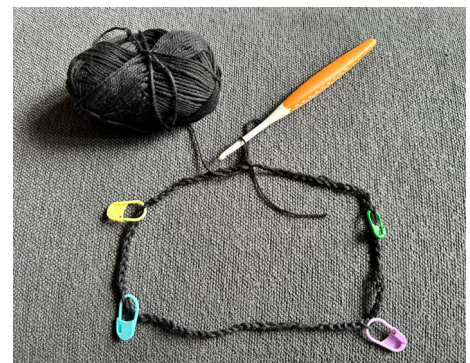
Abbreviations

in next	sts to be worked into same stitch	sp	space
pm	place marker	ss	slip stitch
rep	repeat	*	work instructions immediately following *, then rep as many times as directed
rnd	round		
inc	increase by dtr,ch3, dtr in same	dtr2tog	work two dtr together (this is a decrease).

Pattern instructions Short and Long-Sleeved Top

Rnd 1: Ch 90 (or as many as needed to comfortably fit over your head and create the neckline you want.) Carefully ss to beg ch-1 without twisting.

Fold neck band in half, placing the beginning of the round (yarn tail end) in the centre of one of the longer sides. Count along 6 stitches from the fold and place sm in 6th stitch, Repeat this for the opposite edge of the neckband. You should have 2 sm opposite each other. Repeat this for the other end of the neckline. These 4 sm are where you will do the raglan increases for the yoke.



Rnd 2: Ch 6, sk2, dtr. *Ch2, sk2, dtr. Rep from* until dtr before sm sp. Ch2, dtr in the sm sp. Ch 3 and dtr in same space. Move sm up. Repeat from * until end of round. Ss to 4th stitch of beg ch-6.



Rnd 3: Rep rnd 2 until yoke reaches your armpits. For me (UK 12/14) this was 8 times.

Try on top and check fit! Do this regularly, and see “**adjustments**” section below if you need to make any inc or dec to get the fit you want.



Rnd 4: As rnd 2 until **the last ch-2,dtr- before sm. Dtr into thar st, ch8 (or required number of ch for top to fit comfortably under the arms) and dtr into sm sp, joining the top to create an armhole. Ch2, sk2, dtr, until ** and rep for second arm hole to just before beg of rnd. After last ch-2 sk-2, ss to 4th st of ch-6.

Rnd 5 onwards: Ch6, sk2, dtr. ***Ch2, sk2, dtr. Rep from *** to end of rnd. Ss to 4th st of ch-6. When top is the desired length, fasten off and weave in the ends.

Adjustments

Keep trying on for size.

If a more fitted style is preferred, decrease as follows:

After rnd 4, move sm from armpits. Find the centre point of each armpit and place sm there. Work this round as rnd 5 until the sm. At sm dtr2tog. Continue working round until the next sm and dtr2tog. Ch2, sk2, dtr until end of rnd. Ss to 4th st of beg ch-6.

Try on again, and repeat decrease round if necessary.

To make a more oversized, looser fitting top, increase as follows:

After rnd 4, move sm from armpits. Find the centre point of each armpit and place sm there. Work this round as rnd 5 until the sm. At sm inc by dtr,ch3, dtr in same sp. Continue working round until the next sm and inc as before. Ch2, sk2, dtr until end of rnd. Ss to 4th st of beg ch-6.

Try on again, and repeat decrease round if necessary.

For a more defined neckline, after rnd 1, ch1 and dc into each st around neckline, ss to beg ch-1 before beginning rnd 2. Repeat this for armholes and hemline if desired.

Sleeves

For each sleeve:

Join yarn to top of a dtr at the armpit.

Rnd 1: Ch6, sk2, dtr. Ch2, sk2, dtr to end of round. Ss to 4th st of beg ch-6.

Rep rnd 1 until sleeve is the desired length. Fasten off and weave in the ends.





About me

My name is Vikki Bruff. I'm a freelance crochet designer and French teacher. I live in sunny Barnsley, where I help run our local crochet and knitting group, Yarn in Tarn, as well as teaching children to knot and crochet in primary schools. You can see examples of my work on Instagram @vee_bee_x